RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization con
cerning the functions of the Committee, RECALLING ALSO resolution MSC.402(96), by which
it adopted the Requirements for maintenance, thorough examination, operational testing,
overhaul and repair of lifeboats and rescue boats, launching appliances and release gear
("the Requirements"), which has become --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en
/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.559(108).pdf rescue boats, lau
nching appliances and release gear ("the Requirements"), which has become mandatory unde
r chapter III of the International Convention for the Safety of Life at Sea (SOLAS), 197
4 ("the Convention"), as amended by resolution MSC.404(96), RECALLING FURTHER article VI
II(b) and regulation III/3.25 of the Convention concerning the procedure for amending th
e Requirements, TAKING INTO ACCOUNT the amendments to the LSA Code adopted by resolution
MSC.535(107), with respect to ventilation means, and openings of the ventilation system
and their means of closing for totally enclosed lifeboats, RECOGNIZING the need to keep
the Requirements up to date with regard to annual thorough examination and operational t
esting of ventilation systems, HAVING CONSIDERED, at its 108th session, amendments to th
e Requirements, proposed and circulated in accordance with VIII(b)(i) of the Convention,
1 ADOPTS, in accordance with Article VIII(b)(iv) of the Convention, amendments to the --
- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MS
CResolutions/MSC.559(108).pdf 1 ADOPTS, in accordance with Article VIII(b)(iv) of the Co
nvention, amendments to the Requirements for maintenance, thorough examination, operatio
nal testing, overhaul and repair of lifeboats and rescue boats, launching appliances and
release gear, the text of which is set out in the annex to the present resolution; 2 DET
ERMINES, in accordance with article VIII(b)(vi)(2)(bb) of the Convention, that the amend
ments shall be deemed to have been accepted on 1 July 2025, unless, prior to that date,
more than one third of the Contracting Governments to the Convention or Cont racting Gov
ernments the combined merchant fleets of which constitute not less than 50% of the gross
tonnage of the world's merchant fleet have notified the Secretary -General of their obje
ctions to the amendments; 3 INVITES SOLAS Contracting Governments to note that, in accor
dance with article VIII(b)(vii)(2) of the Convention, the amendments shall enter into fo
rce --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResoluti
ons/MSCResolutions/MSC.559(108).pdf with article VIII(b)(vii)(2) of the Convention, the
amendments shall enter into force on 1 January 2026 upon their acceptance in accordance
with paragraph 2 above; 4 REQUESTS the Secretary -General, in conformity with Article VI
II(b)(v) of the Convention, to transmit certified copies of the present resolution and t
he text of the amendments contained in the annex to all Contracting Governments to the C
onvention; 5 ALSO REQUESTS the Secretary-General to transmit copies of this resolution a
nd its annex to Members of the Organization which are not Contracting Governments to the
Convention.

RESOLUTION MSC.559(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE REQUIREMENTS FOR MAIN
TENANCE, THOROUGH EXAMINATION, OPERATIONAL TESTING, OVERHAUL AND REPAIR OF LIFEBOATS AND
RESCUE BOATS, LAUNCHING APPLIANCES AND RELEASE GEAR (RESOLUTION MSC.402(96)) MSC 108/20/
Add.1 Annex 28, page 2 ANNEX AMENDMENTS TO THE REQUIREMENTS FOR MAINTENANCE, THOROUGH --
- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MS
CResolutions/MSC.559(108).pdf MSC 108/20/Add.1 Annex 28, page 2 ANNEX AMENDMENTS TO THE
REQUIREMENTS FOR MAINTENANCE, THOROUGH EXAMINATION, OPERATIONAL TESTING, OVERHAUL AND RE
PAIR OF LIFEBOATS AND RESCUE BOATS, LAUNCHING APPLIANCES AND RELEASE GEAR (RESOLUTION MS
C.402(96)) 6 SPECIFIC PROCEDURES FOR INSPECTION, MAINTENANCE, THOROUGH EXAMINATION, OPER
ATIONAL TESTING, OVERHAUL AND REPAIR 6.2 Annual thorough examination and operational tes
t 1 Paragraph 6.2.3 is replaced by the following: "6.2.3 For lifeboats (including free-f
all lifeboats), rescue boats and fast rescue boats, the following items shall be thoroug
hly examined and checked for satisfactory condition and operation: .1 condition of the b
oat structure including fixed and loose equipment (including a visual examination of the
external boundaries of the void spaces, as far as practicable); .2 engine and propulsion
system; .3 sprinkler system, where fitted; .4 air supply system, where fitted; .5 manoeu
vring system; --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localresources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofI
MOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.559(108).pdf .2 engine and propulsion system; .3 sprink
ler system, where fitted; .4 air supply system, where fitted; .5 manoeuvring system; .6
power supply system; .7 bailing system; .8 fender/skate arrangements; .9 rescue boat rig
hting system, where fitted; and .10 ventilation system, where fitted." RESOLUTION MSC.55
9(108) (adopted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE REQUIREMENTS FOR MAINTENANCE, THOROUGH
EXAMINATION, OPERATIONAL TESTING, OVERHAUL AND REPAIR OF LIFEBOATS AND RESCUE BOATS, LAU
NCHING APPLIANCES AND RELEASE GEAR (RESOLUTION MSC.402(96)) RESOLUTION MSC.559(108) (ado

pted on 23 May 2024) AMENDMENTS TO THE REQUIREMENTS FOR MAINTENANCE, THOROUGH EXAMINATIO N, OPERATIONAL TESTING, OVERHAUL AND REPAIR OF LIFEBOATS AND RESCUE BOATS, LAUNCHING APP LIANCES AND RELEASE GEAR (RESOLUTION MSC.402(96)) --- URL: https://wwwcdn.imo.org/localr esources/en/KnowledgeCentre/IndexofIMOResolutions/MSCResolutions/MSC.490(103).pdf RESOLU TION MSC.490(103) (adopted 14 May 2021) RECOMMENDED ACTION TO PRIORITIZE COVID-19 VACCIN ATION OF SEAFARERS MSC 103/21/Add.1 Annex 15, page 1 I:\MSC\103\MSC 103/21/Add.1 ANNEX 1 5 RESOLUTION MSC.490(103) (adopted 14 May 2021) RECOMMENDED ACTION TO PRIORITIZE COVID-1 9 VACCINATION OF SEAFARERS THE MARITIME SAFETY COMMITTEE, RECALLING Article 28(b) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Co mmittee, RECALLING ALSO that the Council, at its thirty-first extraordinary session, urg ed flag and port States to ensure the welfare of seafarers, in particular that their rig hts to wages, shore leave, sick leave, access to medical care, food supplies and repatri ation were preserve